

TECHNICAL REPORT ON THE INAUGURATION OF THE LOCAL ORGANIZING COMMITTEES FOR THE SOUTH EAST MIGRATION DIALOGUE

Date: Tuesday, March 10, 2026

Venue: WhatsApp Virtual Meeting Platform

Introduction

The maiden edition of the South East Migration Dialogue at the sub national level commenced with the official inauguration of its Local Organizing Committees (LOCs). The virtual meeting, which saw the participation of 18 committee members, marked a significant step towards structuring migration governance within the region. The session focused on establishing leadership, setting objectives, and outlining the strategic direction for the upcoming dialogue.

Proceedings

The meeting commenced with an opening prayer at 3:06 PM, followed by a welcome brief delivered by Chief Jeto, the South East Coordinator. He set a collaborative tone for the session, after which a comprehensive introduction of the committee members was conducted. The group comprised national and state thematic leads, state coordinators, and key stakeholder representatives from MDAs and the state ministries.

A pivotal moment of the inauguration was the formal announcement of the Chair and Co-Chair for this sub national program. In his acceptance speech, the Chairman extended his appreciation to the members for their commitment. He charged the team to approach the migration platform with an open mind, emphasizing the need to focus on the inherent benefits and opportunities rather than solely on the challenges. He highlighted that organized migration is a catalyst for risk reduction and the enhancement of opportunities, particularly in skills exchange and regional development.

Echoing this sentiment, the Co-Chair affirmed that the establishment of these LOCs is a valid and essential step, serving as a concrete template to pilot the affairs of the migration program effectively. The dialogue quickly moved from ceremonial formalities to strategic planning, yielding critical insights for the way forward:

- **Decentralization and Dignity:** A call to advocate the localization and decentralization of migration management and also a dignified integration of returnees into their communities which requires the state to provide a robust structure that ensures a secure landing and a genuine opportunity for returned migrants to begin anew.
- **Strategic Advocacy:** This expressed the need to leverage high level advocacy. A key strategy proposed was writing to and following an advocacy visit to the First Lady of Abia State to introduce the project. Furthermore, the committee plans to collaborate with the office of the First Ladies in the region by utilizing the First Ladies' Forum platform. Representatives will conduct similar advocacy in the other South East states
- **Operational Structure:** To ensure efficient execution, the committee agreed to create a subcommittee. This team will be headed by a Chairman and supported by a secretariat drawn from the main committee. Their primary role will be to execute tasks and operations to maintain continuity and accountability.

Immediate Next Steps

To maintain momentum, the committee agreed on the following immediate actions:

- **Formalize the Sub Committee:**

The primary next step is to set up and announce the members of the subcommittee during the next general meeting. A standardized template will be developed to harmonize the work of this committee and ensure synergy.

- **Refine the Budget and Concept:**

The team will build upon the draft concept note that has already been shared and develop a feasible budget for a two-day Migration Dialogue.

- **Audience Identification and Outreach:**

A core insight from the meeting was the necessity to clearly identify the audience as every stakeholder with a migration mandate. The state coordinators will take the lead in ensuring that formal letters of invitation are distributed to Very Important Personalities to secure their attendance.

- **Secure a Date:**

A definitive date for the South East Migration Dialogue will be secured and communicated during the next meeting.

Highlights of Abia State Commitments

Dr. Charles provided a highlight of the progress made in Abia State. He reported that a significant milestone has been achieved by securing the buy-in of the Wife of the Abia State Governor. This endorsement is expected to galvanize political will and ensure the success of the dialogue.

Conclusion

The meeting concluded on a note of unified purpose, with the closing prayer said at 4:15 PM. The inauguration successfully laid the groundwork for a structured and impactful South East Migration Dialogue, driven by a committed and strategically oriented committee.

Signed



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Secretary, CSONETMADE, Abia State.